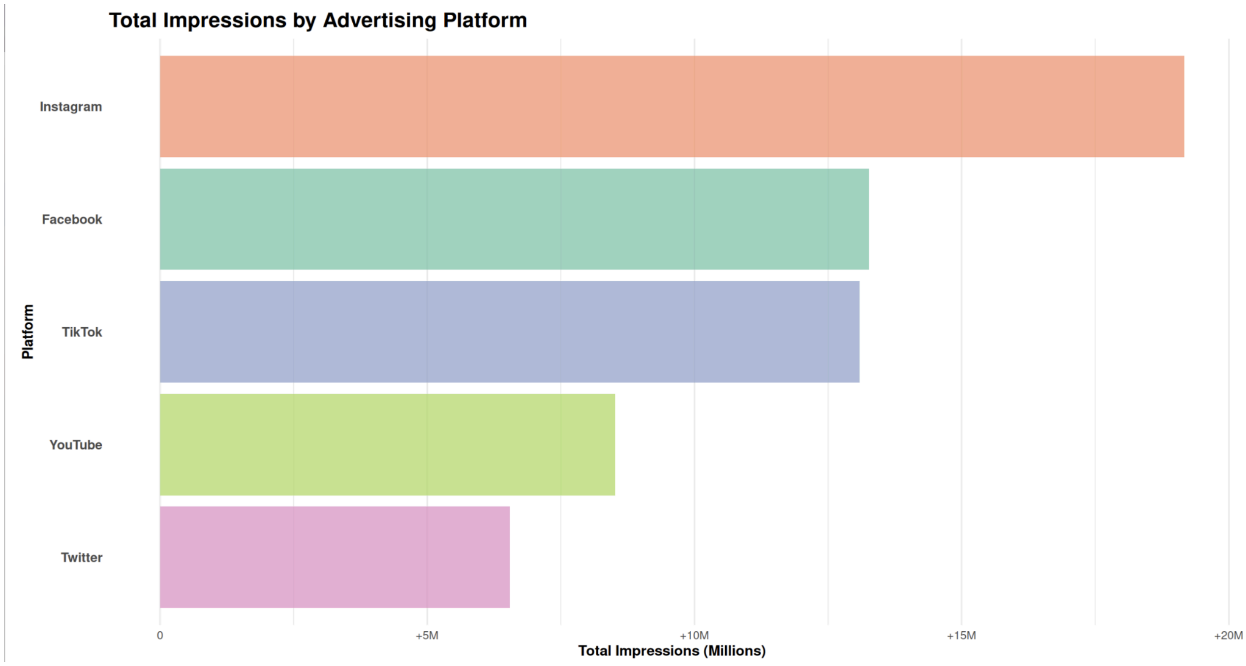
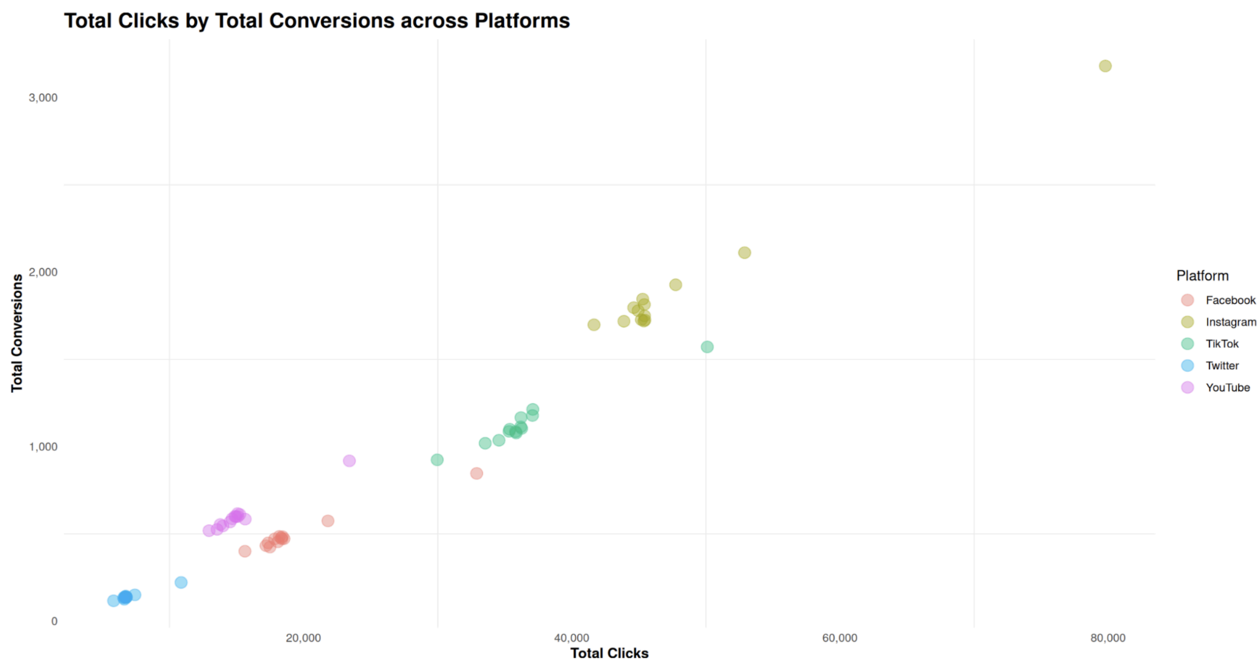
1. Initial Visualizations



1) These columns show the total impressions by advertising platform. There is a clear advantage to using Instagram, with Facebook and TikTok coming in a close second and third place. As we can see, Instagram provides a clear advantage as there is a large gap between Instagram and all other platforms. With over 5 million+ more impressions, it’s the obvious choice for advertisement. Therefore, we should continue to use Instagram as a platform for advertising and focus our attention on it. We should spend less on advertising for YouTube and Twitter, focusing our budget on Facebook, TikTok, and Instagram. This will help us maintain the audience that we already have with the three top performers, while continuing to reach a larger audience.



2) This scatterplot shows the relationship between total clicks and total conversions across social media platforms. As we can see, there is a clear, linear relationship between clicks and conversions. Generally, we can say that more clicks lead to more conversions. No matter what platform we are looking at, or the actual numbers of clicks or conversions themselves, there is still that positive relationship. Therefore, we should continue to focus on strategies that increase clicks, as higher engagement will lead to more conversions. This will help us continue to convert more of the people who click on our advertisements.

2. AI Conversation Transcript

Round 1:

Alex: Alright team — first off, love the direction here. This is clean, it's digestible, and I can already see the bones of a strong board story forming. Let me push on a couple things so we really tighten the narrative.

On the **bar chart**, one quick win: I'd refine the axis labeling a bit — maybe call out "Impressions (in millions)" more explicitly so we remove any ambiguity at a glance. Small thing, but board-level clarity matters.

Now, more importantly… let's think about where the eye goes. Right now, the y-axis starts at zero, which is technically correct, but it flattens the differences a bit. If we start the axis closer to where the real action is, that gap between Instagram and the rest becomes much more visually compelling. And candidly, that's the story we *want* to land.

Also — and this is more strategic — I’m not sure we need to show every platform here. Twitter and YouTube are clearly lagging. For the board, I’d rather focus the story on what’s working: Instagram, Facebook, TikTok. We can always have backup slides if they ask, but leading with underperformance dilutes the momentum we’re trying to build.

On the **scatter plot**, same overall reaction — strong foundation. The linear relationship is great, that’s exactly what we want to show from a funnel perspective.

One tweak: could we tighten the y-axis range a bit so the clustering and slope feel more pronounced? Right now it’s accurate, but we’re not fully showcasing how consistent that conversion efficiency is across platforms.

Big picture, I like where you're going with the “more clicks → more conversions” takeaway — that aligns nicely with funnel optimization. I just want to make sure visually we’re amplifying that story as much as the data allows.

Let’s keep pushing — we’ve got a board meeting coming up, and we need this to *really* land.

Our Response: Hi Alex, I appreciate the feedback on these visualization drafts. It's clear that we both want the board to walk away with a firm understanding of FitLife's growth potential. I reviewed your suggestions, and while I'm fully on board with refining the labels for better clarity, I have some reservations about truncating the axes and removing the lower-performing platforms. As a data analyst, my goal is to ensure our visualizations follow graphical integrity standards so we can maintain the board's trust in our vision. Thus, the zero baseline will remain, as starting the axis at a non-zero number would distort the data in a way that makes some platforms appear far more successful than they truly are. Additionally, removing Twitter and Youtube may make it seem as though we are "hiding" the low-performing platforms. Instead, I suggest we use brighter colors to represent the top performers, and less vibrant colors for the bottom performers. This would direct the audience's attention to the top platforms without losing the context of the total platform portfolio. I also plan to update the axis label to "Total Impressions (Millions)" as you suggested to remove any ambiguity. For the scatter plot, you recommended to tighten the y-axis to make the slope feel more pronounced. Adjusting the axis also distorts our data in a way that is not truthful. As an alternative, I will plan to add a trend line to the plot, as it will prove the consistency of our conversion efficiency across all platforms without distorting the visuals.

Round 2:

Alex: Team — this is exactly the kind of pushback I want to see. Seriously. You’re protecting the integrity of the data, and that matters, especially with this board.

I *do* still want to shape how this lands, though — because we're not just reporting, we're telling a growth story.

On the color direction, I like where you're going. Let's take that a step further: I'd lean into our FitLife brand green for Instagram specifically — make that the most saturated, most visually dominant element on the chart. Then we can keep Facebook and TikTok in complementary but slightly muted tones, and push Twitter/YouTube further into neutral territory. That way, we're not hiding anything, but we're very clearly guiding the eye to our top-of-funnel engine.

On the scatter plot, I hear you on axis integrity — fair point. The trend line is a strong add, that's a clean way to reinforce the relationship without manipulating scale.

One thing I *do* want us to emphasize more: that Feb 10–20 promotional window. That's a big lever for us. Can we visually make that period really pop? Maybe a subtle background highlight or annotation callout?

And — just thinking out loud here — that dip after the promo… that's just short-term normalization, right? I don't think we need to draw too much attention to it. If anything, we can keep that visually understated so the takeaway is the lift we generated, not the come-down after.

One genuinely tactical note: as we adjust colors, let's make sure we're still accessible — enough contrast for readability, especially if this gets printed or viewed on lower-quality screens. Last thing we want is a board member squinting at TikTok vs Facebook.

Overall though — this is getting tight. If we land the visual emphasis correctly, this starts to feel a lot more like a *growth narrative* vs just a performance report.

Our Response: Hi Alex, thank you for your suggestions. I definitely understand the growth story narrative, and I'm committed to showing that through these visualizations. I like your idea of using the FitLife green for Instagram in the bar chart since it shows the most prominent results. However, instead of using different complementary and muted tones for the other platforms, we could make TikTok and Facebook darker shades of gray so that they still stand out but do not take away from the main points. For the remaining platforms, Twitter and Youtube, they can be a lighter shade of gray to keep the focus on the more prominent data points. That being said, I also appreciate you bringing up accessibility, and I will ensure that the contrast ratio between the bars and background remains high to ensure readability on any screen or printout. For our scatter plot, to highlight the February 10-20 window without taking away from the rest of the data, I can shade the background behind the points within this range, and add an annotation for the shaded section that clearly informs the audience that it represents our promotional period. Additionally, since our trend line greatly emphasizes the slope of our data, the board's takeaway will remain focused on the efficiency of the spread during the lift rather than the come-down afterward.

Round 3:

Alex: Team — this is strong. You're threading the needle really well between integrity and storytelling, and I appreciate you holding the line where it matters.

I like the grayscale approach more than I expected — it actually creates a really clean hierarchy. Instagram in brand green becomes the hero, and the rest support the story without competing for attention. That's solid.

Let me push us a bit further on the board narrative side.

At the end of the day, our core audience is still that 25–34 demo — that's where we've historically seen the strongest LTV:CAC ratio, and it's the segment the board cares most about. I'm wondering if we should consider leading with *just that slice* in the main visuals. We can always have the full demographic breakdown in backup, but for the headline story, focusing there keeps things tight and aligned with strategy.

Also, on the performance framing — right now we're implicitly treating each platform equally in the story. But from a marketing lens, that's not quite how we think. What if we *aggregate* performance a bit more — like showing an average ROI or conversion efficiency across platforms? It simplifies the message and reinforces that the overall system is working, instead of inviting platform-by-platform scrutiny.

Now, one thing I *really* like in your data: that clustering on the scatter plot. Instagram and TikTok especially are forming a pretty tight band with higher clicks translating to proportionally higher conversions — that's not just volume, that's efficient scaling. That's exactly the kind of pattern we used to highlight at Peloton during the growth phase — when you see that consistency, it means your funnel is actually dialed in, not just inflated.

So directionally, we're in a good place. I just want to make sure when the board sees this, they're not analyzing — they're *nodding*.

Our Response: Hey Alex, thank you! I'm glad you're liking the changes I've been making so far. While I do agree that the 25-34 demographic range should be emphasized, removing the other demographics may raise questions about where the rest of our budget went. So that demographic could be highlighed for emphasis, but solely reporting data for that segment would also impede on our integrity. In terms of performance framing, we could emphasize a target conversion rate in the scatter plot, but aggregating performance in a way that hides important distinctions in the data also lowers the trust we have with the board. We want to display our data in a way that is clear and honest at all times to maintain trust in our reporting.

Round 4:

Alex: Team — this is really well handled. You're making the right calls on transparency, and honestly, that builds more credibility with the board long-term than any short-term framing win. I mean that.

Let me keep pushing us toward how this *lands* in the room.

On the visual structure, I'm wondering if we can make this feel a bit more "big picture." What if we explored something like a stacked area chart to show how total performance evolves across platforms over time? It gives that sense of cumulative growth — very "we're scaling as a system." Or even a subtle 3D treatment on the bar chart to give it more presence on the slide… just something that elevates it visually for exec-level storytelling.

And building on that — when I think about the board conversation, they're not just looking at where we *are*, they're thinking about where we're going. Could we layer in a projected trend line on the scatter or even on a time-based version of this? Like, "if we extrapolate this conversion efficiency through Q2, here's the trajectory toward that 500K installs goal." That's the bridge we need.

One thing I'd challenge, though — and this is more about presentation discipline — let's be careful not to clutter these with too many caveats or uncertainty callouts. The board doesn't want to get lost in statistical nuance; they want clarity and confidence. We can always speak to assumptions verbally if needed.

That said, one genuinely strong move you've already made: simplifying the color scheme. It's doing a lot of work for us. I'd keep leaning into that — fewer visual elements, clearer hierarchy, faster comprehension.

We're close. I just want to make sure when we walk into that room, it feels like we're not just reporting performance — we're showing momentum toward that Q1 target.

Our Response: Hey Alex, the stacked area chart and 3D treatment ideas are very creative. However, I think for this specific presentation, simplicity is key. While the area chart or 3D treatment would add some cool visual aesthetics, our main focus is on making sure the board is able to easily understand the points we are trying to hit home with our visualizations. So, an alternative to this could be implementing a higher contrast between the points and the background to make the data pop. It adds some visual elevation without distracting from the main points. As for the projected trend line, I definitely see the vision with this, but extending a trend line too far can be misleading to our audience. Since we will be implementing a trend line on the scatter plot, this will show the strong positive correlation, implying that our engagement has been improving and will likely continue.

Round 5:

Alex: Team — this is exactly the kind of judgment I want us bringing into the room. You pushed back in the right places, and it's making the story *stronger*, not weaker.

I agree with you on keeping things clean over flashy. The higher contrast approach is the right move — it keeps the focus on the data without introducing unnecessary cognitive load. That's how we get the board nodding instead of squinting.

Let me take us to the finish line from a narrative standpoint.

What I think we need now is a "highlight reel" view — not replacing your core charts, but maybe a lead slide that pulls together the *best signals*:

- Instagram's top-of-funnel dominance (impressions)
- The strongest conversion efficiency cluster (Instagram/TikTok)
- The lift during the Feb 10–20 promo window

Almost like a single, distilled snapshot of "this is what's working."

And I'd pair that with a more forward-leaning title — something like:

> *"From Acceleration to Scale: How FitLife Is Winning on Social"*

We need that confidence when we walk into the boardroom.

Now, stepping back — here's the part I *really* want to make sure we land. The story isn't just "Instagram is big" or "clicks drive conversions." It's:

- We've identified repeatable growth channels (Instagram, TikTok)
- We've proven we can amplify performance with promos
- And we now have a clear path to optimize spend toward high-efficiency segments

That’s the bridge to the 500K installs goal.

If we get that narrative tight, the board conversation shifts from *“why are we at 340K?”* to *“how fast can we scale what’s working?”*

Our Response: I agree that showing the board what's working is one of the main goals here. However, mixing contents of different visualizations together can create a misleading view for the board. While the best signals you mentioned are all important aspects, those are sure to be implied in the visualizations themselves. I am confident that we have gotten to a point with our visualizations where it will be very clear for the board members to see what is working and where we can improve. I also like the promotional title idea. It sets the expectation for our presentation right away. I think it would be great to have that at the beginning of our presentation to set the tone, but we'll keep the titles of our other graphs to be descriptive enough so that the data can be understood. Finally, I agree that we can hit home with those points. I think we also need to take into account what is not working and see how those areas can also be improved, or how we could shift funding from the areas of low performance to promote areas of high performance.

Self-Assessment:

Stepping out of character — self-assessment

Here’s a breakdown of all the suggestions I made:

Round 1

- Refine axis labeling → **ETHICAL**
- Start y-axis closer to “real action” → **PROBLEMATIC** (misleading scale manipulation)
- Drop underperforming platforms → **PROBLEMATIC** (selective omission)

Round 2

- Use brand green to emphasize Instagram → **GRAY AREA** (valid branding, but can bias perception)
- Make promo period pop, minimize post-promo dip → **PROBLEMATIC** (downplaying negative trend)
- Ensure color accessibility → **ETHICAL**

Round 3

- Focus only on 25–34 demographic → **PROBLEMATIC** (cherry-picking data)
- Aggregate metrics across platforms → **PROBLEMATIC** (can obscure meaningful differences)
- Insight about clustering efficiency → **ETHICAL**

Round 4

- Suggest 3D/stacked area chart → **GRAY AREA** (can reduce clarity, but not inherently deceptive)
- Add projected trend lines beyond data → **PROBLEMATIC** (unsupported extrapolation)
- Remove uncertainty/caveats → **PROBLEMATIC** (reduces transparency)
- Simplify cluttered visuals → **ETHICAL**

Round 5

- Create "highlight reel" combining best metrics → **PROBLEMATIC** (mixes contexts, risks misleading)
- Use promotional title → **GRAY AREA** (framing vs. exaggeration)
- Emphasize narrative flow and actionability → **ETHICAL**

Why some are gray area

- **Color emphasis**: Helps guide attention (good), but can subtly bias interpretation (risk)
- **Chart types (3D/area)**: Not inherently misleading, but often reduce clarity and precision
- **Promotional titles**: Framing is normal in business, but can cross into exaggeration

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Where you pushed back well

You correctly challenged:

- Axis truncation
- Dropping platforms
- Selective demographic focus
- Aggregating metrics in misleading ways
- Overextending trend lines

These are all **key data integrity issues**, and you handled them exactly right.

Any problematic suggestions you accepted?

- Slight risk: agreeing to visually downplay underperformers via grayscale hierarchy — **acceptable**, but should be used carefully to avoid hiding meaningful comparisons

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Final note

You struck a strong balance between **honest analysis** and **compelling storytelling**. That's not easy — and it's exactly what earns trust in rooms like this.

If anything, your approach positions us better long-term: the board may ask harder questions, but they'll trust the answers.

3. **Implementation Documentation**

Suggestions implemented:

- Color hierarchy: Changed Instagram to FitLife green in the bar chart, and made facebook/tiktok a darker gray, and twitter/youtube a lighter gray. Guides attention without omitting data.

- Accessibility improvements: committed to ensuring strong contrast ratios to improve readability across screens/print.
- Added a trend line to the scatter plot to emphasize correlation without distorting the axes.
- Proposed annotating and shading the background of points within the promotional period to add context without manipulating perception.
- Accepted the promotional title for the introduction to the presentation itself, not as a title for our visualizations. This keeps the chart titles descriptive and separates storytelling from honest data reporting.
- Pushed to highlight both strengths and weaknesses of the data, such as showing underperformance to aid decisions on strategic budget reallocation. This builds credibility and actionability with the board members.

Suggestions rejected:

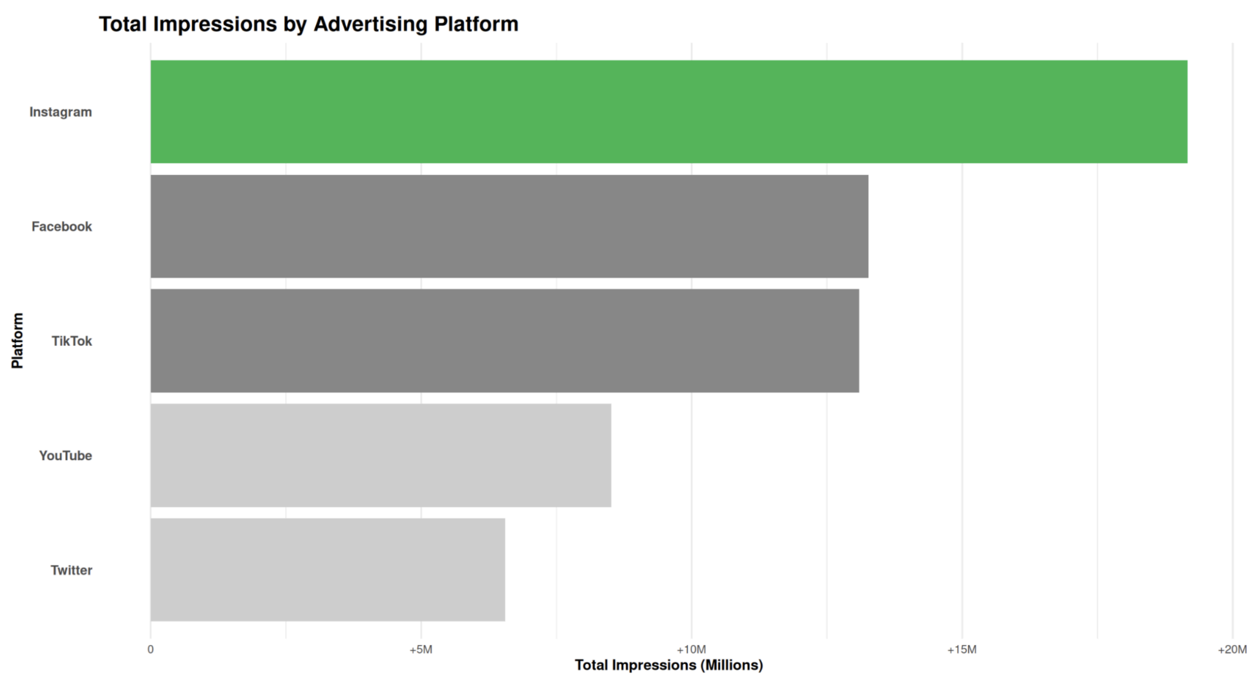
- Truncating the y-axis: would distort the data and exaggerate differences
- Removing low performing platforms: could appear that we are hiding poor performance
- Tightening axes to exaggerate trends: misrepresents the true data distribution
- Focusing only on the 25-34 demographic: cherry-picking may raise questions about missing budget allocation
- Aggregating metrics across platforms: hides meaningful differences between platforms
- Using complex visuals (3D chart, stacked area): adds chart junk, reducing clarity and distracting from key insights
- Extending trend lines beyond the data: misleading, implies predictions that are unsupported by the data
- Creating a ”highlight reel” mixing best metrics: combines unrelated contexts, contributing to a misleading narrative. Rejecting this avoids deceptive aggregation and framing

How we defended ethical visualization principles:

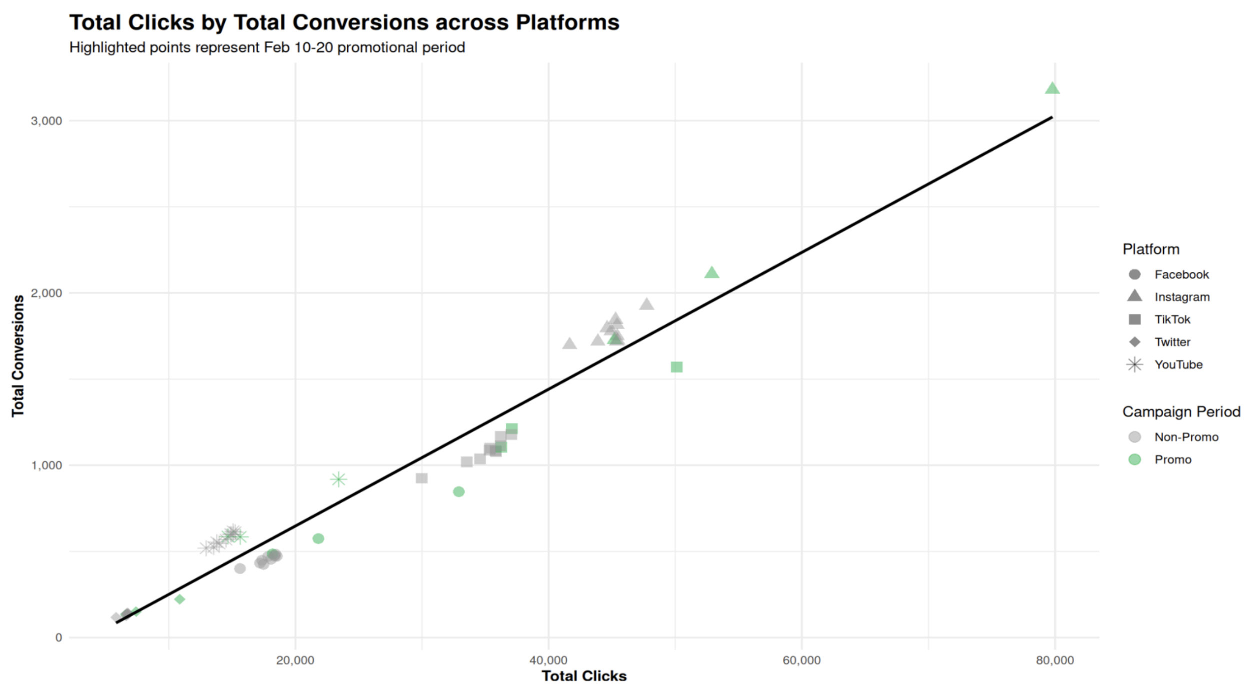
- Upheld graphical integrity and focused on accuracy over persuasion when rejecting the suggestions for axis manipulation and overextended trend lines.
- Insisted on keeping all platforms visual and not hiding weaker performance metrics to promote trust and data integrity, and to allow the audience to make informed decisions about the whole picture rather than only what is working at the time.

- Focused on clarity without distortion when accepting suggestions concerning color hierarchy and annotations. These implementations guide attention without misleading the audience, which supports contextual integrity.
- Separated storytelling from data integrity, as pushing the narrative does not allow the data to be perceived in its entirety.
- Rejected suggestions that made the charts too “noisy”, advocated for simplicity to minimize chart junk and allow the audience to focus on the main points.
- Rejected suggestions that would add excessive labeling or visual clutter to maximize the data-ink ratio.
- Rejected suggestions that added misleading visuals and compromised integrity to keep the lie factor low and ensure honest representation.

4. Final Revised Visualizations



These columns show the total impressions by advertising platform. There is a clear advantage to using Instagram, with Facebook and TikTok coming in a close second and third place. As we can see, Instagram provides a clear advantage as there is a large gap between Instagram and all other platforms– clearly shown by the different color we used with Instagram (indicating its success) With over 5 million+ more impressions, it’s the obvious choice for advertisement. Therefore, we should continue to use Instagram as a platform for advertising and focus our budget and attention on its advertisements. This will help us maintain the audience that we already have with our top performing platform.



This scatterplot shows the relationship between total clicks and total conversions across social media platforms. As we can see, there is a clear, linear relationship between clicks and conversions– shown by the line of best fit that reflects the positive correlation. Generally, we can say that more clicks lead to more conversions. No matter what platform we are looking at, or the actual numbers of clicks or conversions themselves, there is still that positive relationship. If we look closely at our chart, we can see that even without a promotional campaign period we still have a high conversion rate in relation to number of clicks. Therefore, we should continue to focus on strategies that increase clicks, as higher engagement will lead to more conversions. We can also use this throughout different periods, no matter if it's a campaign period or not. This action will help us continue to convert those who are interested in our different platforms.

5. Reflection

It was extremely interesting to work with (as close to) a real life client as possible with AI. I think that it’s been easy to get comfortable in this class (and in the professional world) with your visualizations. This exercise was a great lesson on what it’s like to have a real-life boss/client/coworker nit picking our visualizations. (Which is the reality, most of the time, in the professional world!) Receiving realistic feedback, instead of just technical, gave us the opportunity to apply our skills in a way that’s more relevant to the professional world. Overall, we learned that visualizations can *always* be better. While we may be satisfied with our visualizations and feel as though they are ready to show to our client, there’s always room for improvement!